

The Algorithm Alliance

A united front built on efficiency, strategy, and smart solutions.

MEET THE GROUP

Brian Rivera



I am an undergraduate student at the University of Puerto Rico, Mayagüez Campus (UPRM), currently in my third year pursuing a Bachelor's degree in Computer Science. I enjoy learning through hands-on projects and prefer to fully understand the reasoning behind solutions rather than relying on memorization. During my studies, I have gained experience working with technical concepts related to computing systems, logic, and fundamental engineering principles. These experiences have strengthened my critical thinking skills and attention to detail. I am motivated by challenges that require both creativity and precision, and I value collaboration in team based environments while also being comfortable working independently when needed. My goal is to continue growing as an engineer by expanding my technical knowledge. I aim to use my technical skills to design and implement solutions that are efficient and reliable. In the future, I aim to gain industry experience, continue learning new technologies, and develop adaptable skills that will allow me to thrive in the field of computer science. Through this course, I hope to strengthen my understanding of software design, testing strategies, and best practices for writing maintainable code, while also improving my collaboration and communication skills in a team oriented setting.

Caleb Ligon



I'm a second-year Cybersecurity major at Hampton University. I'm originally from Indianapolis, Indiana, but when I'm not on campus, I live in Charlotte, North Carolina. On campus, I stay pretty involved. I'm a sophomore ambassador for our cybersecurity club, an active member of NSBE, and also part of ACM. I've had some exposure to Python from my time mentoring in the Microsoft BAM program, but I'm still learning and improving. I've also built two basic personal websites on my own and another one for a class assignment, so I have some very basic familiarity with web development. Most of my coding experience is in Java, where I've built a few different programs for school projects and assignments. Cybersecurity is what I'm really passionate about. I enjoy learning through hands-on platforms like TryHackMe, the National Cyber League, and CyberChef, where I've been able to practice skills like penetration testing, file navigation, and encryption. I've worked in teams before through robotics and hackathons, so I'm used to collaborating and problem-solving with others. I haven't worked on a website like this in a group setting yet, but I'm really excited to learn, contribute, and work with so many smart and motivated people. I'm looking forward to collaborating with everyone!

Kenneth Ye



I'm a Junior Computer Science student at Florida International University. I grew up in Ecuador but I was born in the U.S. which is why I'm pursuing a career in the States. My love for programming has roots in messing around with commands and code logic in games like Minecraft, mixed with my over-exposure to many different languages throughout my life like English, Spanish, Mandarin and Cantonese. I took some robotics classes in high school but much preferred the software side of technology and learned basic front-end development during my sophomore & junior years. Being mainly self-taught has helped me gain a flexible perspective when it comes to looking at obstacles, and made me develop a habit developing an idea or project from scratch many times to find more efficient or easier ways to achieve the same goal. I have previous experience working in a group setting to deploy a project by a certain deadline and know what it takes to deploy a project successfully. I look forward to familiarizing myself more with working in group settings, as I'm not as comfortable as I'd like to be with version control and teamwork in software-related contexts, and connecting with people to learn both with and from them.

Oluwanifemi Elias



I am a sophomore computer science major with a minor in mathematics at Howard University. My interest in computer science began when I was ten years old after taking a Scratch class, which introduced me to problem-solving and logical thinking through programming. That class sparked my curiosity and motivated me to explore coding outside the classroom. After learning Scratch, I began teaching myself HTML and CSS, which allowed me to better understand how websites are built and made me want to learn more about how computers work. As the year went by, my passion for computer science deepened through coursework and projects that strengthened my foundation in programming, algorithms, and problem solving. I am particularly interested in how technology can be used to solve real-world problems and create meaningful impact, especially in education and finance. Outside of academics, I am an active member of ColorStack and the National Society of Black Engineers which has helped me with exploring different opportunities related to computer science. These organizations have really helped me come out of my comfort zone. Overall, I am excited to work on creating a website with a group. I feel like it will help strengthen both my soft and technical skills.

Natalia Camejo del Valle



My name is Natalia Camejo Del Valle, and I am an undergraduate student at the University of Puerto Rico–Mayagüez pursuing a degree in computer science and engineering. I am interested in the intersection of technology, problem solving, and creativity, particularly how computing can be used to build systems that have real-world impact. I enjoy working on challenging problems, learning new technical concepts, and applying them in practical and meaningful ways. Coming into this class, I bring prior knowledge in programming fundamentals. While I am still developing confidence in more advanced topics, I am actively working on improving my logical thinking and understanding of how programs work behind the scenes. In addition to coursework, I have been involved in research, collaborative projects and competing in a few hackathons where I have learned the importance of teamwork, clear communication, and iterative improvement. These experiences have taught me that learning programming is not just about writing correct code, but also about understanding errors, asking good questions, knowing how to work with your group and refining solutions over time. I am entering this class motivated to strengthen my fluency in English, my technical skills, deepen my understanding of programming concepts, and become more independent and efficient in solving computational problems.

TEAM EXPECTATION AND AGREEMENTS

- **What are our team goals for this project and the class?**
 - Get stronger in python.
 - Familiarize ourselves further with version control.
 - Understand the ins and outs of authentication.
 - Resume worthy project.
 - Learn to collaborate with people that are far away.
- **What are each of our strengths? (note: include any strengths, not just technical CS knowledge)**
 - Brian:
 - Technical Strengths: Python, Java, Robot Operating Systems(basic knowledge)
 - Non Technical Strengths: Organization, Time management, Adaptability, Proactive
 - Caleb:
 - Technical Strengths: Some experience with basic web dev (VERY BASIC websites)
 - Non Technical Strengths: utilizing and finding resources to help achieve intended goal (deep dive on web, reddit, stack overflow, chatgpt, etc), Communicating with group members
 - Femi:
 - Technical Strengths: HTML, CSS, Prompt engineering
 - Non Technical Strengths: Communication, Creativity, Organization
 - Kenneth:
 - Technical Strengths: semi-fluent in React, Vue, CSS
 - Non Technical Strengths: Adaptability, problem solving, thinking outside the box
 - Natalia :
 - Technical Strengths: Knows GitHub
 - Non Technical Strengths: Organization, Creativity, Persistence

- **How will we communicate with each other?**
 - WhatsApp group chat/ weekly meeting on zoom
 - If the group needs additional meeting time outside of our scheduled time we can do an extra impromptu zoom meeting with members who are available.
- **How quickly should we expect to hear back from each other?**
 - Messages in the group chat should be viewed or acknowledged (like message, etc) within 24hrs.
- **What day/time in the week will we meet every week?**
 - Wednesday 7:00pm - 7:50pm
- **What are our rules for our weekly meetings?**
 - Meetings should be a maximum of 1hr.
 - Have a specified topic or purpose whether it's brainstorming, checking progress from last meeting, speaking about new features, etc).
 - Have a running document for all meetings to keep track of work we have done over the duration of the project (alternate note taker each meeting).
 - If a member cannot attend a meeting, text group chat.
- **How will we run the meetings?**
 - Recap for the week.
 - Solution to any problem that any might have.
 - Go over tasks for the following week.
- **What should we each prepare before each weekly meeting?**
 - If possible, have a **list of topics** to be talked about ready before the meeting begins.
 - Have a **recap** of what we did throughout the week or since the last meeting.
 - Maybe have a constant google document that we use every meeting to write down notes or important changes/suggestions.
- **When we get a group assignment, how will we divide the work? What if there is an unequal load of work in an assignment? How will we rotate roles through the class (e.g. team leader, notetaker, who submits the assignment, etc)?**
 - Play to members strengths, If someone is particularly good with python libraries

or knows about API's have them implement it into the project.

- If someone has an eye for design, have them work on the front end of the project.
- **What will we do if a member cannot work for a specified period of time due to an unforeseen circumstance? How will the team react? How will the team get the work done?**
 - If a member cannot make it to a meeting or is overwhelmed with personal life or school send a message and communicate with the group so we know. Hopefully within 2 hours of the meeting
 - If an emergency arises and you have to miss a meeting just let the group know as soon as you can.
 - The group should aim to have everyone attend each meeting but the group will be understanding of unforeseen circumstances causing absence.
 - If you miss a meeting it is your responsibility to check the notes from the meeting you miss.
 - If the person's task needs to be done urgently then we find a way to split it up for the rest of the group to do it, so we don't miss a deadline. (To make sure no one is misusing this, we have to provide a brief explanation for why you can't do your tasks,).
- **How do we collectively decide when to submit group assignments?**
 - At group meetings we will discuss how we feel prior to submissions as well as having a group review before submitting.
 - If meeting is not possible before a submission deadline we will result to the group chat and review work individually then come to a consensus on whether it is submission worthy.
- **What are our group's rules about using genAI? *Remember that each teammate is responsible for their own work, whether genAI is used or not.***
 - If you use gen AI to generate code **CITE IT** to avoid plagiarism.
 - You should understand the code before using it in the project.
 - Use genAI to help teach anything we may need to add to a project, don't just trust the code before reviewing it.
 - Before you decide to use AI try to see if a group member has experience doing.

that task and then ask them to help you if they can.

- **What happens if one of us breaks the rules in this agreement?**
 - If behavior is neglectful to the group to the point it negatively affects our ability to complete tasks, or properly communicate, behavior will be brought up to the Instructor. (This is not to out anyone or be weird but to hold one another accountable).

TEAM SIGNATURES

Name: Oluwanifemi Elias [OE]

Date: 01/17/2025

Name: Caleb Ligon [CL]

Date: 01/17/2025

Name: Kenneth Ye [KY]

Date: 01/17/2025

Name: Brian Rivera [BR]

Date: 01/17/2025

Name: Natalia Camejo Del Valle [N]

Date: 01/17/2025